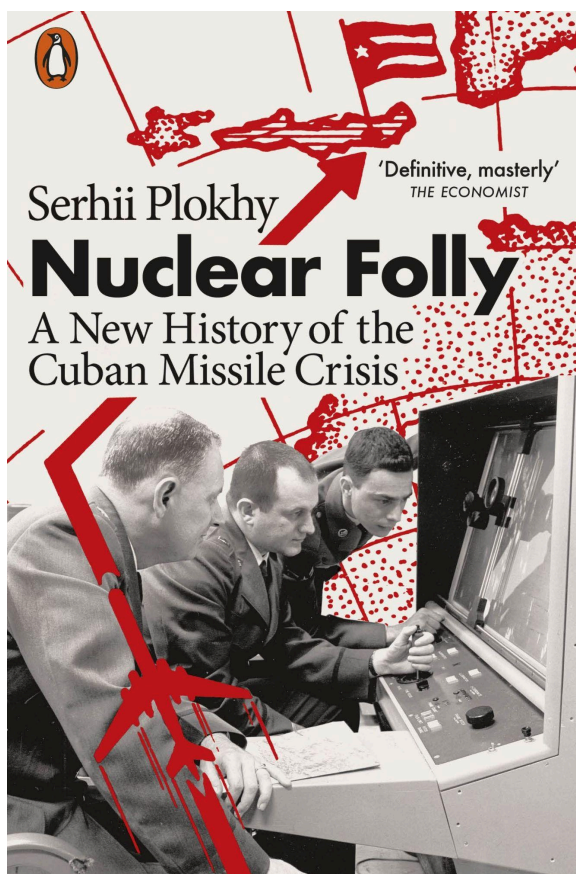




UNIVERSITY INTERSCHOLASTIC LEAGUE

Social Studies

District • 2026



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UNIVERSITY INTERSCHOLASTIC LEAGUE SOCIAL STUDIES CONTEST

DISTRICT • SPRING 2026

Part I: General Knowledge

The Global Cold War and Its Fallout: From Yalta to Malta

(1 point each)

1. From the start of his rule in 1955, _____ imprisoned and killed many that he alleged were opposing his regime and aiding communist insurgents. After government forces killed several people at a rally celebrating the Buddha's birthday in 1963, the U.S. was finally persuaded to withdraw its support, and his generals assassinated him during a coup d'état.

A. Ho Chi Minh	C. Deng Xiaoping
B. Ngo Dinh Diem	D. Le Duc Tho

2. By 1977, guerrilla activity was pervasive in Nicaragua and President _____'s National Guard was accused of retaliating with wholesale murder. He was a fervent anti-Communist and had enjoyed backing from the U.S. government, but when President Carter withdrew support in 1979, he resigned, fled to Paraguay, and was assassinated in 1980.

A. Augusto Pinochet	C. Anastasio Somoza Debayle
B. Carlos Castillo Armas	D. Ernesto Guevara

3. The _____ was adopted as a part of U.S. foreign policy after World War II and predicted that if a noncommunist state became communist it would result in the failure of noncommunist governments in neighboring states. It was first proposed by President Truman and popularized by President Eisenhower.

A. domino theory	C. rollback effort
B. containment policy	D. Marshall Plan

4. In 1985, the U.S. National Security Advisor sold weapons to Iran in the mistaken belief that the sale would secure the release of U.S. hostages in _____. The sales went against the policy of refusing either to bargain with terrorists or to aid Iran. Some of the funds from the sales were given to the Contras in Nicaragua.

A. Iraq	C. Lebanon
B. Palestine	D. Iran

5. Though the attempt by Communist hard-liners to seize control of the Soviet Union by holding Mikhail Gorbachev captive in August of 1991 collapsed in a matter of days, it significantly undermined Gorbachev's political standing and _____.
A. led to his removal as Chairman of the Supreme Soviet
B. inspired the Baltic Way in Estonia, Lithuania, and Latvia
C. accelerated the collapse of the Soviet Union.
D. was followed by Boris Yeltsin ordering his arrest
6. _____ was appointed Soviet ambassador to the U.S. by Nikita Khrushchev in March 1962 and served until 1986. His tenure spanned five Soviet leaders and six U.S. presidents and provided a vital continuity to U.S.-Soviet relations during the Cold War.
A. Oleg Gordievsky
B. Anatoly Dobrynin
C. Aleksei Kosygin
D. Oleg Penkovsky
7. In 1947, Czechoslovakia's Foreign Minister showed interest in participating in the Marshall Plan. Stalin refused to give his approval and in February 1948, a communist coup occurred in Czechoslovakia. Though _____ was retained as foreign minister, it was reported on March 10, 1948, that he committed suicide by jumping out of a third-story window.
A. Alexander Dubček
B. Jan Masaryk
C. Edvard Beneš
D. Václav Havel
8. By allowing the Germans to suppress the _____ of 1944, Soviet authorities helped eliminate the main military support for the Polish government-in-exile in London. Consequently, there was little effective political resistance when the Soviets occupied all of Poland.
A. Warsaw Uprising
B. Tbilisi Riots
C. Poznań Riots
D. Solidarity Movement
9. _____ supported the idea of a united Europe, but wanted it to be free from the superpowers' influences. He fought to keep the U.K out of the European Economic Community because of its U.S. ties and in 1966, he pulled France's forces out of NATO due to concerns about U.S. control.
A. Guy Mollet
B. Georges Pompidou
C. René Coty
D. Charles de Gaulle

10. As Poland's government came under increasing pressure from the Solidarity trade union, _____ was elected premier in 1981. In an effort to crush Solidarity, he declared martial law. In 1988, he changed course and approved negotiations with the previously outlawed Solidarity.
- A. Władysław Gomułka
B. Lech Wałęsa
C. Wojciech Jaruzelski
D. Andrei Gromyko
11. At least 10 CIA agents were executed as a result of _____'s spying. Before he and his wife Maria were arrested in 1994, they received over \$2.7 million, the most paid by the Soviet Union/Russia to any U.S. spy.
- A. Robert Hanssen
B. Klaus Fuchs
C. Aldrich Ames
D. George Blake
12. The Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty was signed on July 1, 1968, by the U.K., U.S., USSR, and 59 other states. Countries that possessed nuclear weapons agreed not to assist other states in obtaining or producing them. By 2010, only India, _____, and Pakistan had refused to sign the treaty, and only North Korea signed and then withdrew.
- A. Ukraine
B. France
C. China
D. Israel
13. During WWII, the U.K. and the USSR occupied Iran. In 1946, the U.S. demanded Soviet troops withdraw. The Iran Crisis ended when Stalin finally backed down, but he tried to retain influence by forcing Iran to agree to oil concessions and Soviet-backed _____ and Kurdish regimes in the north. However, the Iranian government revoked these deals as soon as the Soviets left.
- A. Afghani
B. Chinese
C. Iraqi
D. Azerbaijani
14. As Soviet foreign minister, _____ helped implement Mikhail Gorbachev's policy initiatives including the withdrawal of troops from Afghanistan, the negotiation of new arms treaties, and allowing the fall of communist governments across Eastern Europe. He resigned suddenly in December 1990, to protest the influence of anti-reformers in the government.
- A. Andrei Sakharov
B. Stanislav Petrov
C. Georgi Malenkov
D. Eduard Shevardnadze

15. The _____ aimed to establish relations between both German states and granted legal recognition to the German Democratic Republic. Each side recognized the other's authority and refused to represent the other internationally. That meant West Germany abandoned its claim to be the sole legitimate representative of the German people.
- A. Treaty on the Final Settlement with Respect to Germany C. Helsinki Accords
B. Moscow Treaty D. Basic Treaty
16. The _____ was the fourth of the Arab-Israeli wars and was initiated by Egypt and Syria on October 6, 1973, lasting until October 26, 1973. The war eventually drew both the U.S. and the USSR into indirect confrontation in defense of their respective allies.
- A. Suez Crisis C. Lebanon Crisis
B. Six-Day War D. Yom Kippur War
17. The Treaty of Economic, Social, and Cultural Collaboration and Collective Self-Defense, also known as the _____, was signed by Britain, France, Belgium, the Netherlands, and Luxembourg in 1948 and created a collective defense alliance that led to the formation of NATO.
- A. Brussels Defense Pact C. Bretton Woods Agreement
B. Paris Charter D. Morgenthau Plan
18. In response to the Soviet blockade of Berlin in 1948, Allied cargo planes used air corridors over the Soviet zone to deliver food, fuel, and other goods to the western part of the city. This project, code-named "Operation _____" by the U.S. military, became known as the "Berlin Airlift" or the "Air Bridge" to West Berliners.
- A. Vittles C. Golden Pheasant
B. Blue Bat D. Round Robin
19. When GATT was concluded by 23 countries at Geneva in _____, it was meant to be replaced by a U.N. agency. When such an agency failed to emerge, it was enlarged and played a major role in the massive expansion of world trade until it was replaced by the World Trade Organization.
- A. 1954 C. 1973
B. 1961 D. 1947

20. Under director _____, from 1957 to 1989, the Stasi became a highly effective secret police organization in East Germany. It sought to infiltrate every institution of society and every aspect of daily life through its official apparatus and a vast network of informants and collaborators.
- | | |
|--------------------|--------------------|
| A. Walter Ulbricht | C. Erich Honecker |
| B. Erich Mielke | D. Konrad Adenauer |

Part II: Primary Source Material

***Nuclear Folly: A History of the Cuban Missile Crisis*, by Serhii Plokhy**

(2 points each)

21. According to Khrushchev, the proposal by _____ for an immediate first strike on the U.S. with nuclear missiles came as a shock not only to him, but also to the others around the table. “When this was read to us, we, sitting in silence, looked at one another for a long time.”
- | | |
|----------------|----------------------|
| A. Che Guevara | C. Fidel Castro |
| B. Issa Pliev | D. Rodion Malinovsky |
22. The year 1962 brought unprecedented economic hardship to Cuba. In February, President Kennedy introduced new sanctions against the island, closing the U.S. market not only to Cuban sugar but also to Cuban _____.
- | | |
|-----------|------------|
| A. cigars | C. bananas |
| B. zinc | D. flour |
23. Castro’s threat to _____, first made in his letter of November 15th to U Thant, brought the situation back to the brink of war. Vasilli Kuznetsov did his best to distance himself and his country from Castro’s actions.
- | | |
|-----------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| A. resume shooting at U.S. planes | C. broker a military deal with China |
| B. use tactical nuclear weapons | D. bar any and all inspections |
24. The news that reached the White House on the morning of August 31, 1962, could not be concealed or downplayed. General Marshall S. Carter told President Kennedy that a U-2 spy plane had discovered Soviet _____ in Cuba.
- | | |
|----------------------------|------------------------|
| A. IRBM missiles | C. IL-28 bombers |
| B. surface-to-air missiles | D. troops and barracks |

25. General Stepan Grechko belonged to an elite group of Soviet commanders closely associated with Khrushchev. These included Marshall Moskalenko and Grechko's direct supervisor, General Batisky, who had personally shot Khrushchev's archrival _____, in 1953.
- | | |
|--------------------|-----------------------|
| A. Lavrentii Beria | C. Vyacheslav Molotov |
| B. Georgi Malenkov | D. Lazar Kaganovich |
26. "Khrushchev was seriously alarmed by the news that _____," recalled his aide Oleg Troianovsky. He sensed the danger that he was losing control over his own men and "was keenly aware...that in the situation that had arisen...a single spark might cause an explosion."
- | |
|--|
| A. Castro had rejected the removal of missiles |
| B. an anti-aircraft missile had been fired |
| C. submarines had entered the quarantine area |
| D. a captain was refusing to allow inspections |
27. In August 1962, _____, a Republican Senator from New York, told Congress that "the Soviets are constructing missile bases and sending over technicians and experts to man them" in Cuba.
- | | |
|-------------------|--------------------|
| A. Charles Curtis | C. Kenneth Keating |
| B. Strom Thurmond | D. Henry Jackson |
28. _____ disliked the surgical strike option, but was also critical of the diplomatic option. He proposed a new course to impose a naval blockade on Cuba.
- | | |
|-------------------|--------------------|
| A. Robert Kennedy | C. John McCone |
| B. McGeorge Bundy | D. Robert McNamara |
29. On October 28, 1962, the Secretary of the Soviet Defense Council reported to the Presidium that President Kennedy was to address the U.S. the next day. Khrushchev ordered Dobrynin be given instructions to tell Robert Kennedy that Moscow was prepared to accept his brother's conditions. They believed they had to react promptly because _____.
- | |
|--|
| A. Castro would have to make a speech in response |
| B. it was likely NATO troops movements would be announced |
| C. once an invasion was announced it could not be reversed |
| D. airstrikes would likely begin before the speech |

30. The eighty-six-year-old dean of U.S. literature, _____, came to greet the new president and pass the torch of moral leadership. In a poem, he wrote for Kennedy's inauguration, but was unable to read, he claimed Kennedy heralded, "The glory of a next Augustan age."
- A. Allen Ginsberg
B. Robert Frost
- C. William S. Burroughs
D. John Gillespie Magee
31. On October 27, 1962, President João Goulart of _____ informed Castro that he had forty-eight hours to dismantle the Soviet missiles or be attacked.
- A. Chile
B. France
- C. Brazil
D. Spain
32. At a meeting on November 5, 1962, Castro told Mikoyan that the will of the Cuban people was that they _____. "If our position puts peace throughout the world at risk... we will resist by ourselves. Come what may." The statement had the force of an exploding bomb.
- A. no longer consider the USSR an ally
B. would fight any blockade
- C. would not accept inspections
D. preferred invasion over surrender
33. On October 23, 1962, when John and Robert Kennedy were alone, they reflected on the declaration of the blockade. The president said, "It looks like hell-looks real mean. Doesn't it?" Robert said, "Well, there isn't any choice. I mean you would have been, you would have been _____. " The president did not disagree.
- A. impeached
B. hounded by the military
- C. destroyed in the media
D. seen as weak by our allies
34. On October 28, 1962, President Kennedy placed calls to three of his predecessors, _____, Harry Truman, and Dwight Eisenhower, to report the victory, but not how it was achieved.
- A. Richard Nixon
B. Herbert Hoover
- C. Calvin Coolidge
D. Woodrow Wilson
35. With plans for producing new missiles in the works, Khrushchev still needed a quick solution to his missile gap problem. In May of 1962, he found it on his trip to _____, where Cuba and missiles were very much on his mind.
- A. East Germany
B. the United States
- C. Austria
D. Bulgaria

Part III: Supplemental Readings
(3 points each)

36. In Josef Stalin's speech on February 9, 1946, he expressed his belief that World War II broke out as the inevitable result of _____.
A. fascism
B. capitalism
C. democracy
D. imperialism
37. In 1961, Undersecretary of State Chester Bowles believed the new U.S. administration was doing particularly well in Africa and Latin America and had a chance to improve its position in areas of Asia. He felt that opportunity could be lost by embarking on a major covert adventure in _____.
A. Guatemala
B. Berlin
C. Cuba
D. Vietnam
38. In 1960, the Castro-led government in Cuba confiscated private property and sent agents to initiate revolutions in several Latin American countries. The U.S. cut off sugar purchases and placed an embargo on all exports to Cuba except food and medicine. In early January 1961, _____ broke diplomatic ties with Cuba.
A. John Kennedy
B. Dwight Eisenhower
C. Richard Nixon
D. Harry Truman
39. In 1950, after a conflict with the Stalinists, _____ was expelled from the party in Hungary and jailed. He was rehabilitated and joined Imre Nagy's short-lived government. After Soviet troops took over the country on November 4, 1956, he deserted Nagy and formed a new government with Soviet support and remained in its leadership until 1988.
A. János Kádár
B. Pál Maléter
C. Ernő Gerő
D. Mátyás Rákosi

"I am proud to come to this city as a guest of your distinguished Mayor, who has symbolized throughout the world the fighting spirit of West Berlin."

40. On June 26, 1963, President Kennedy began his address to the people of West Berlin by thanking their mayor, _____.
A. Konrad Adenauer
B. Willy Brandt
C. Lucius D. Clay
D. Ernst Reuter

41. The Suez Crisis was precipitated by the U.S. and U.K. decision to no longer finance Egypt's construction of the _____, in response to Egypt's growing ties with communist Czechoslovakia and the Soviet Union.
- A. Port of Said
B. Straits of Tiran
C. Aswan High Dam
D. Suez Canal
42. In 1954, Secretary of State John Foster Dulles accused Guatemalan President Jacobo Árbenz of installing "a communist-type reign of terror" and plotting to spread communism throughout the region after nationalizing property owned by _____.
- A. Texaco
B. United Fruit Company
C. North American Sugar Industries
D. Dole Pineapple Company
43. In President Truman's address to Congress on March 12, 1947, he stated that, "If Greece should fall under the control of an armed minority, the effect upon its neighbor, Turkey, would be immediate and serious." He then claimed that if the U.S. did not act, "disorder might well spread" to _____.
- A. the Middle East
B. Southeast Asia
C. the rest of Europe
D. Africa

"The potential for the disastrous rise of misplaced power exists and will persist. We must never let the weight of this combination endanger our liberties or democratic process...Only an alert and knowledgeable citizenry can compel the proper meshing of the huge industrial and military machinery of defense with our peaceful methods and goals..."

44. The quote above is from _____ in 1961.
- A. John Kennedy
B. Dwight Eisenhower
C. Bernard Baruch
D. James Byrnes
45. In his telegram to the U.S. Department of State on May 20, 1965, Ambassador Charles Bohlen expressed displeasure over statements by _____ about Yalta and how he had "distorted the meaning and significance of this Conference."
- A. Nikita Khrushchev
B. Josip Broz Tito
C. Konrad Adenauer
D. Charles De Gaulle

ESSAY PROMPT:

NOTE: Contestants who do not write an essay will be disqualified. Any essay that does not demonstrate a sincere effort to discuss the assigned topic will be disqualified. The rankings of essays will be based primarily on how well the topic has been addressed. A focused, concise and specific essay beats a vague and rambling essay. Proper grammar and organization should be used to aid clarity, but should not be considered a major factor in scoring. Cover as many corners of the issue as practical. Avoid including personal editorialized opinions, as more than enough information on the subject has been published.

“Fidel had a choice to make in the months to come. He was no Marxist ideologue. In fact, simply put, he was the first Fidelista...His challenge was to find a course of action that guaranteed him continued control over the revolution and the destiny of his people. At the same time, the challenges for Raúl and Che would be to convince this man that the future prospects of his...movement would depend on creating a much closer relationship with Moscow and Beijing. As of the summer of 1959 the Kremlin could do little but watch and wait...”

-Aleksandr Fursenko and Timothy Naftali, “One Hell of a Gamble”

Cuba was arguably the most dynamic Cold War ally of the Soviet Union outside of the Eastern Bloc, but the relationship started slow and was not always warm. Identify and discuss the key events and issues that marked the development of the alliance between Cuba and the USSR and how it impacted specific global conflicts of the 1960s and 70s.

UNIVERSITY INTERSCHOLASTIC LEAGUE
SOCIAL STUDIES CONTEST
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ANSWER KEY

Part I (1 point each)	Part II (2 points each)	Points contestants could mention in their essay:	China
1. B	21. C (pg. 286)	Background •After Fulgencio Batista left Cuba on Jan. 1, 1959, Fidel Castro's nationalist revolution was in control. Castro began to extend the government's economic control early, but it was not avowedly Marxist. He visited the U.S. in 1959 on a Goodwill Tour, but by 1960 he alienated the U.S. with nationalization of businesses and land-holdings. A trade agreement with the USSR was agreed to in Feb. 1960. The U.S. put a partial embargo in place and broke diplomatic ties by Jan. 1961.	•As Mao and Khrushchev moved their countries towards conflict, Cuba was neutral. Che Guevara supported the Maoist approach to increased international confrontation with the West and Castro disliked Soviet-US détente, but Cuba needed Soviet economic support and remained neutral.
2. C	22. A (pg. 43)		•Castro reaffirmed support for the USSR under Brezhnev by endorsing the application of his Doctrine in Czechoslovakia in 1968.
3. A	23. A (pg. 344)		Angola
4. C	24. B (pg. 99)	Bay of Pigs •In April, 1961, the U.S. attempted an exile-led invasion of Cuba that failed due to limited U.S. military backing and support from Cubans on the ground.	•During the Cold War, Cuban foreign military expeditions were framed as proxy-fighting by the USSR. More recently, these activities have been shown to be more independent. Cuba supported revolutionary goals, but often through more aggressive maneuvers than what the Kremlin wished for.
5. C	25. A (pg. 243)	•Castro declared the Cuban Revolution to be socialist the next month and began receiving military aid from the USSR.	•In 1975, Cuba sent troops and war materiel to Angola to support the MPLA. They helped establish the MPLA as the de facto government of Angola with Soviet support.
6. B	26. B (pg. 277)	•In Dec., he declared himself a Marxist-Leninist.	•Cuban troops were the key to repelling South African advances into Angola and help stabilize the MPLA government until the 1990s.
7. B	27. C (pg. 100)	Khrushchev was hesitant to claim Cuba as fully Communist, but their relations were strengthened	•The USSR tried limiting Cuban troops' autonomy.
8. A	28. D (pg. 142)	Cuban Missile Crisis •Khrushchev used Cuba to circumvent the Soviet missile gap with the U.S. by agreeing to place IRBMs on the island.	Ethiopia •Cuba sent troops to support Soviet efforts to sustain the newly Communist government in Ethiopia during the Ogaden War against Somalia in 1977-78.
9. D	29. C (pg. 283)	•The missiles came along with SAM sites, bombers, and thousands of Soviet troops	•After Castro-led peace efforts failed, over 15,000 Cuban troops were likely the deciding factor in providing the Ethiopian government the ability to retake territory.
10. C	30. B (pg. 6)	•When the U.S. discovered the missiles, a blockade of offensive materiel to Cuba was issued. Castro supported a first strike, but Khrushchev worked for a missile swap and a U.S. pledge not to invade.	•Cuba kept troops to defend Ethiopian outposts.
11. C	31. C (pg. 203)	•Castro felt betrayed by the reversal and thwarted plans for UN-led inspections.	
12. D	32. C (pg. 325)		
13. D	33. A (pg. 178)		
14. D	34. B (pg. 294)		
15. D	35. D (pg. 54)		
16. D	Part III (3 points each)		
17. A	36. B		
18. A	37. C		
19. D	38. B		
20. B	39. A		
	40. B		
	41. C		
	42. B		
	43. A		
	44. B		
	45. D		